MAD MAX

AND THE REVENGE OF THE KILLER PUMPKINS



14 FIELDS OF FRIGHT

Eat every bone

Fourteen gardens, each with fewer places to hide and more pumpkins on your tail

Your keys, your way

Up, down, left, right: you choose the four keys

SID sound

Music for the title and the end, and sound effects from the 6581

Welcome, Max

Pumpkin Patch

It is Halloween, the bones are buried in the garden, and the pumpkins have come alive. **Dig up every bone before they catch you.**

You are Mad Max, a very hungry beagle. Every garden is full of bones, laid out among the flowers, and every garden has pumpkins: grinning, angry, and *hunting you*. They never stop and they never tire.

Eat all the bones in a garden and you move on to the next. Clear all fourteen and you can finally sit down with a nice cup of tea.

What you need

- A Commodore 64 or 64C (PAL), or the VICE emulator (`x64sc`)
- An Ocean-type cartridge (`MadMaxC64.crt`) **or** a 1541 disk (`MadMaxC64.d64`)
- The keyboard. No joystick is used.

Loading the game

Cartridge: plug it in (computer off!), switch on, and the game starts at once. In VICE: `x64sc MadMaxC64.crt`.

Disk: `LOAD"*",8,1` then `RUN` (the program is packed, so it loads in a few seconds). In VICE, just attach `MadMaxC64.d64` and autostart.

In this manual

3 **Controls** — *and your own keys*

4 **The garden** — *what you will meet*

5 **The fourteen gardens** — *every level*

6 **Caught, and glory** — *lives and tips*

7 **Inside the C64** — *and credits*

Quick start

Press Return or N on the title screen, then use A Z N M to move up, down, left and right. Eat the bones. Don't touch a pumpkin.

Warning

They are quicker than they look

Each pumpkin takes about five steps a second. You take one step per key press, so a pumpkin only catches you if you let it. Keep moving, and think about corners.

Getting started

The controls

Four directions and a way out, **on keys you choose yourself**. *Mad Max is a fast, keyboard-only game, so it should fit your hands.*



Title *The four keys, and the question: change them, or play?*

On the title screen

Key	What it does
Return Space or N	Start the game
Y	Change the four keys

Your own keys

The game starts with A up, Z down, N left and M right, as in the original. Prefer something else? Press Y and the game asks for each in turn.

Choosing keys

- Press the key you want for *up*, then *down*, *left* and *right*.
- A key you have already given in this round is not accepted: the game waits for another. Run/Stop is reserved for leaving a game.
- Any other key of the keyboard works, cursor keys and Return included.
- The keys last until you switch the computer off (a cartridge can't save anything).

In the garden

Key	What it does
Your *up* key	One cell up
Your *down* key	One cell down
Your *left* key	One cell left
Your *right* key	One cell right
Run/Stop	Give up and go back to the title



Keys *"Press the key for left": up and down are already chosen.*

One step, one press

Each key press moves Max exactly one cell. Hold a key down and he keeps running, as fast as the key repeat. Only the flowers stop him: they are walls.

Know your garden

The garden

Every garden is 11 cells wide and 9 high, and made from the same few things.
Learn them: *one of them wants to eat you.*



Mad Max

That's you. He always starts in the top-left corner.



Bones

Run over one and Max eats it. Eat them all to finish the garden.



Pumpkins

They look at you, and they come for you, one step at a time. They walk over bones as if they were not there, but never through flowers.



Flowers

A solid wall, for you and for the pumpkins. They surround every garden and divide it into paths.



Four colours

The flowers change colour from garden to garden: pink, blue, purple and sunflower, and then round again.



Gotcha

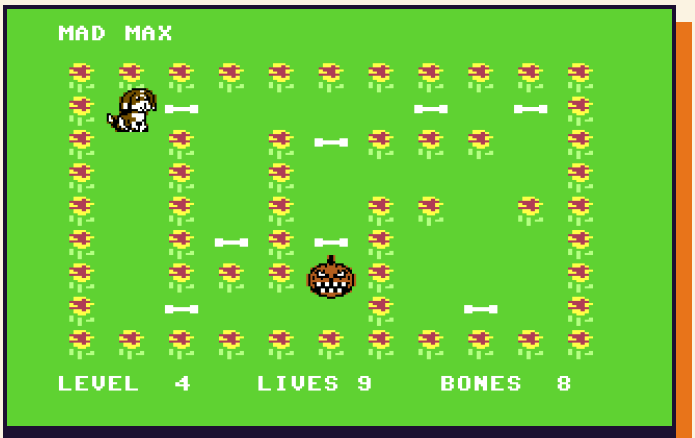
When a pumpkin reaches you, you hear it laugh. That costs a life.

How a pumpkin thinks

Every few moments each pumpkin picks, at random, whether to close in sideways or up and down, and takes a step that way toward you. If a flower is in the way it turns and tries another direction. It does not plan ahead, and it does not remember, so a pumpkin *can* be fooled by a corner.

Pumpkins do not mind bones

A pumpkin walks over a bone as if it were not there, and does not eat it. The bones are all for you. Leave the last one for a safe moment: the garden is finished the instant it is gone.



Level 4 *Eight bones, one pumpkin. Every fourth garden has sunflowers.*

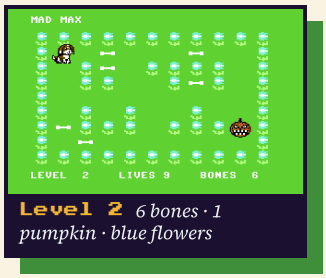
The whole patch

Fourteen gardens

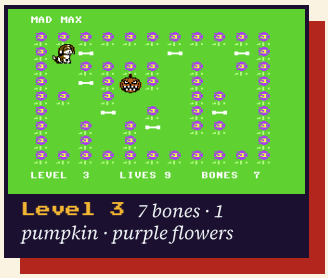
More bones and more pumpkins as you go on. **The first six have one pumpkin, then two, and the last two have three.**



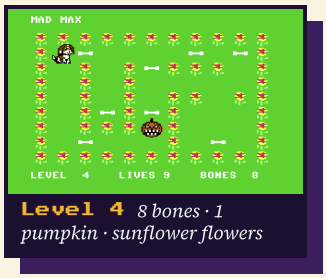
Level 1 *5 bones · 1 pumpkin · pink flowers*



Level 2 *6 bones · 1 pumpkin · blue flowers*



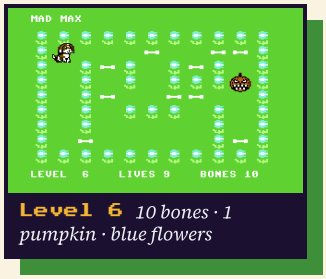
Level 3 *7 bones · 1 pumpkin · purple flowers*



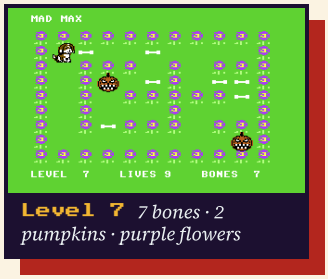
Level 4 *8 bones · 1 pumpkin · sunflower flowers*



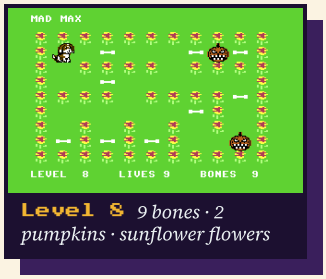
Level 5 *8 bones · 1 pumpkin · pink flowers*



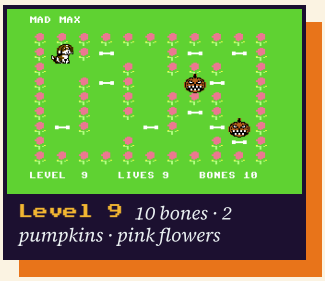
Level 6 *10 bones · 1 pumpkin · blue flowers*



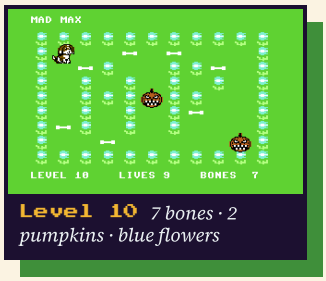
Level 7 *7 bones · 2 pumpkins · purple flowers*



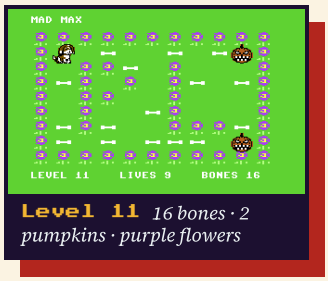
Level 8 *9 bones · 2 pumpkins · sunflower flowers*



Level 9 *10 bones · 2 pumpkins · pink flowers*



Level 10 *7 bones · 2 pumpkins · blue flowers*



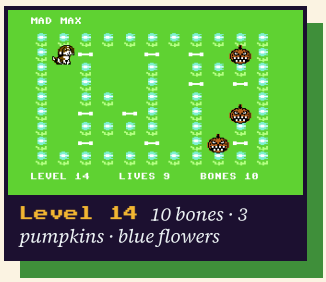
Level 11 *16 bones · 2 pumpkins · purple flowers*



Level 12 *11 bones · 2 pumpkins · sunflower flowers*



Level 13 *10 bones · 3 pumpkins · pink flowers*



Level 14 *10 bones · 3 pumpkins · blue flowers*

Caught, and glory

*You have **nine lives**, and you keep them from garden to garden. They are not unlimited.*

Caught by a pumpkin

The pumpkin laughs, and a box tells you how many lives are left. Then **the same garden starts again from the beginning**: Max back in the corner, the pumpkins back where they began, and all the bones back where they were. The ones you ate don't count.

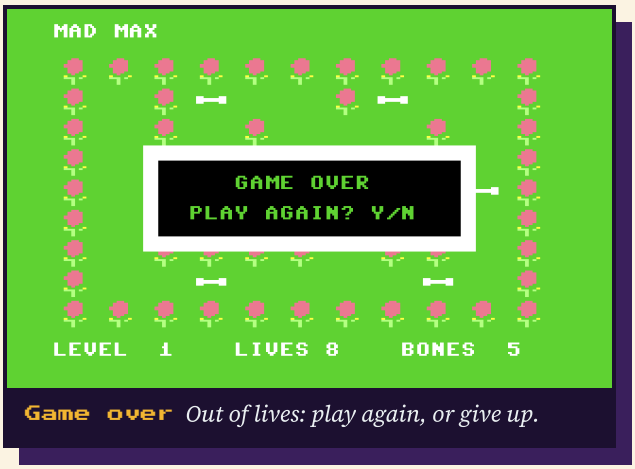


Caught *"Ha ha ha...". Eight lives left.*

Out of lives

When the last life goes, the box says *game over* and asks *play again? y/n*:

- Y or Return: a new game, from garden 1 with nine fresh lives.
- N: *Happy Halloween!!*, and back to the title.



Game over *Out of lives: play again, or give up.*

Winning

Eat the last bone of the fourteenth garden and Max gets his reward. The end picture appears, with music; press any key to skip the tune. Then comes *play again? y/n*.

- Y: back to garden 1, nine lives.
- N: *Happy Halloween!!*, and back to the title.

Tips

- Look at the whole garden before your first step. Take the bones near the pumpkins first, while you have room to run.
- Corridors are dangerous: with a pumpkin behind you, you can't turn round. Lead pumpkins to the wrong side of a wall, then go the other way.
- Run/Stop always gets you back to the title, and costs you only the garden you were in.



The end *"...naughty pumpkin!!" The winner's reward.*

Under the pumpkin

Inside the C64

Dan wrote Mad Max in Applesoft BASIC for the Apple II. **This is the same game**, *with its rules carried over, on the machine with the best sound chip of its day.*

14
gardens, from Dan's level pictures

8X64K
cartridge: instant start, no loading

3
SID voices: melody, harmony and bass

6502
assembly language, no BASIC and no KERNAL

What changed from the original

- Dan's Super Hi-Res art, converted to the C64's multicolor graphics: sprites for Max and the pumpkins, and a character set for the flowers and bones.
- Music for the title and the end, and sound effects for a crunchy bone, the pumpkin's laugh, a new garden and game over, played by the SID.
- The title and the end are multicolor bitmaps with text lines below, switched by a raster interrupt.
- The flowers change colour from garden to garden.
- A box in the middle of the screen shows your lives left.

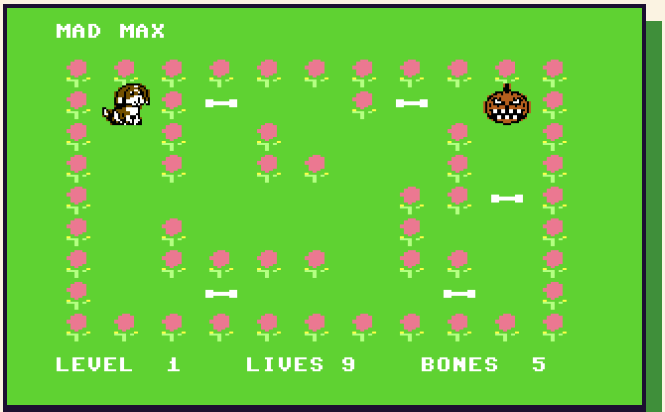
What did not change

- One step per key, keys you choose, nine lives.
- The pumpkins' way of hunting, and the way a garden restarts when you are caught.
- "Play again", and "Happy Halloween!!".

Credits

GAME DESIGN, ORIGINAL APPLE II VERSION, ART
Dan Henderson

COMMODORE 64 VERSION, MUSIC AND SOUND EFFECTS
Walter Tengler



Level 1 *Where it starts.*

Thank you

For Bev, Harvey, Ashton and Max.